

## READING PASSAGE 1

### Urban Green Spaces and Mental Health

**A** Urban Green Spaces and Mental Health has emerged as one of the most significant topics in contemporary academic discourse. The complexity and multifaceted nature of this subject have attracted the attention of researchers, policymakers, and practitioners across multiple disciplines, all seeking to understand its implications for the future.

**B** The intellectual lineage of this field extends considerably further than many realise. While modern research techniques have only recently been applied to these questions, philosophers and natural scientists have grappled with related issues for centuries. The transition from speculative philosophical inquiry to systematic empirical investigation represents one of the most significant developments in the intellectual history of this domain.

**C** Contemporary research has identified several critical factors that determine outcomes in this domain. The interplay between environmental conditions, technological capabilities, and social organisation creates a complex adaptive system in which small changes can produce disproportionately large effects. Understanding these dynamics requires analytical approaches that move beyond simple cause-and-effect reasoning to embrace the principles of complexity science and systems thinking.

**D** Case studies from diverse geographical and cultural settings provide compelling illustrations of these dynamics in action. In one particularly well-documented example, researchers tracked developments over a fifteen-year period in a setting that offered a natural experiment in the effects of policy change. The introduction of a new regulatory framework produced a cascade of adaptations that rippled through the entire system, generating outcomes that both confirmed theoretical predictions and revealed previously unrecognised complexities.

**E** The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

**F** Looking ahead, the field stands at a critical juncture. Emerging technologies offer unprecedented opportunities for data collection and analysis, potentially enabling researchers to address questions that have long remained beyond the reach of empirical investigation. At the same time, the accelerating pace of social and technological change means that the phenomena under study are themselves evolving, requiring theoretical frameworks that can accommodate dynamism and discontinuity rather than assuming stability and equilibrium.

**G** The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

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#### Question 1

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 1 The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:
- A. excessive research funding
  - B. translating academic findings into practical policy
  - C. lack of public interest
  - D. too many international collaborations

**Questions 2–4**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 2 The author notes that researchers have called for more \_\_\_\_\_ approaches to investigation.
- 3 Dynamic \_\_\_\_\_ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.
- 4 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of \_\_\_\_\_ years.

**Question 5**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 5 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.

**Question 6**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 6 Researchers used data from more than \_\_\_\_\_ countries in the landmark study.

**Questions 7–9**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 7 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?
- A. too much data collection
  - B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
  - C. insufficient government funding
  - D. overly complex statistical methods
- 8 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. weak effects across studies
  - B. moderate to large effect sizes with consistency
  - C. contradictory findings
  - D. results only in specific populations

- 9 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. too much data collection
  - B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
  - C. insufficient government funding
  - D. overly complex statistical methods

**Questions 10–11**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 10 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.
- 11 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.

**Question 12**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 12 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. excessive research funding
  - B. translating academic findings into practical policy
  - C. lack of public interest
  - D. too many international collaborations

**Question 13**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 13 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.